

Disable Registry Tools

Remember, only Microsoft's inbuilt Registry tools (yes, regedit included) are blocked by this tweak. To change this back to the way it was, use a third-party Registry editor to change the value back to 0.

Yahoo! Messenger

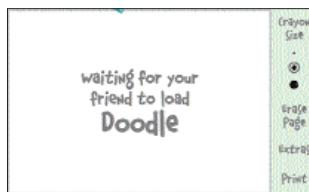


Be a Stalker—I

If you're worried that someone is avoiding you by either signing in as invisible or by changing their stealth setting so that they appear offline to you, here are three simple ways to check.

The first way is to use the Doodle IMVironment. Start an offline conversation with the contact and send them a dummy message. If they're actually online, this should open a conversation window on their machine.

Now, select the Doodle IMVironment from IMVironments > See All IMVironments > Yahoo Tools. If your contact is really offline, you'll see "Waiting for your friend to load Doodle" for a really long time. If, however, your contact is online, the



Loading doodle This is what you will see for a really long time if the contact is offline

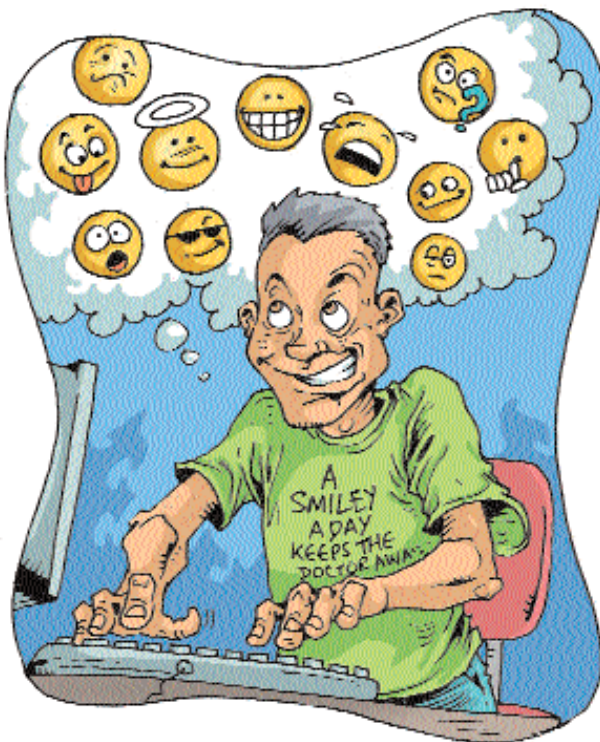
IMVironment should load in less than a minute and let you draw. Ta-da! Now you can satisfy your inner stalker once again.

For the Victims:

If you're being annoyed by someone who's using the above method, you could:

1. Add them to your ignore list, or

INSTANT MESSENGERS



2. Disable IMVironments by going to **Connection > Preferences** and uncheck the "Enable IMVironments" box under Messages.



Be a Stalker—II and III

These methods are quite basic and may not necessarily always work.

Try to start a voice conversation with the contact. If the person is really offline, you will be asked to leave a voicemail after the ringing times out. If the person is invisible, all you'll get is a "No Answer" message.

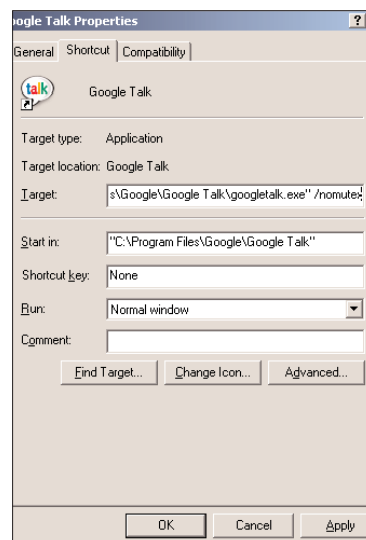
Another way is to invite the person to a conference. If the contact is offline, you'll soon get an error message saying "Conference could not be started". If the contact is online, your conference room will just sit empty till your contact either explicitly declines your invitation or if they finally relent and accept.

Google Talk



Run Google Talk with multiple e-mail addresses at the same time If you've got many Gmail

accounts and don't want to keep logging on and off them every time you want to switch, a simple command line parameter in the Google Talk shortcut can solve your problem. First, create one copy of the Google Talk shortcut on your desktop—leave the original intact. Right-click on this shortcut and select Properties. The Target text box will show you the path of the EXE for



The Google Talk shortcut Properties dialog

Google Talk—something like "C:\Program Files\Google\Google Talk\googletalk.exe"

Change this to "C:\Program Files\Google\Google Talk\googletalk.exe" /nomutex and click OK. You will now be able to run multiple instances of Google Talk with different identities for each.



Other Command line parameters for Google Talk

Just like you added the /nomutex parameter to the Google Talk shortcut, you can use the following parameters for other purposes:

/register: writes Google Talk's settings to the Windows Registry

/checkupdate: checks for new versions of Google Talk

/factoryreset: reverts to the original settings

/mailto email@gmail.com: sends an e-mail through Gmail

/diag: starts Google Talk in diagnostic mode



Google Talk Keyboard Shortcuts

Here are some quick shortcuts to use with Google Talk:

[Ctrl] + [E]—Centre-align text in the chat window

[Ctrl] + [R]—Right-align text in the chat window

[Ctrl] + [L]—Left-align text in the chat window

[Ctrl] + [I] or [Tab]—Cycle through windows

[Ctrl] + [Tab] or [Shift] + [Tab]—Cycle through windows in reverse order

[Ctrl] + [1]—Type single-spaced lines

[Ctrl] + [2]—Type double-spaced lines

[Ctrl] + [5]—Type 1.5-spaced lines

[Ctrl] + [1] (Numeric Keypad)—Go to the end of the last line

[Ctrl] + [7] (Numeric Keypad)—Go to the beginning of the first line

[Alt] + [Esc]—Close all Google Talk windows

[F9]—Send an e-mail to